kept watch on a house in Kalpakkam, south of Madras. They had information that Sivarasan was inside the house. The house was locked, but the flickering of lights suggested there were people inside. It was the season of mangoes. The Black Cat commandos hung around the house in disguise as mango sellers and hid their arms and ammunition inside the fruit baskets. Adding to their inconvenience, people would often approach them to buy mangoes. But the commandos in disguise could not afford to sell the fruit, as it would have exposed the hidden arms.

There was no movement around the house, except for one woman who came out of the house twice to buy something from a shop nearby. After a little over three hours of waiting, Verma and Ravindran broke into the house. They discovered it was a studio for making pornographic films. Hundreds of porn cassettes were stored inside. Sivarasan wasn't here either. Everyone was disappointed. Ravindran tried to boost their morale saying this was their job—to check out every single place or person they were tipped about. A commando quietly asked if he could take one or two cassettes back with him. Ravindran first made a face and then said, 'After everyone has exited.'

Before twenty-four hours were over, another intercepted communication indicated that Sivarasan would be near Peraribalan's house in Kodabakkam. Around the same time, someone called the SIT and claimed that his neighbour had spotted Sivarasan in the house next to his own. The man had tried contacting the SIT but didn't have a phone at home and was too scared to go out, fearing Sivarasan would attack.

Again a large team headed by Kanth, Verma and Ragothaman launched a combing operation in the suspected area before dawn broke. And once again they saw no sign of Sivarasan. While Kaarthikeyan's strategy of the SIT taking the initiative of gathering intelligence and decoding them had paid off, Sivarasan was still proving to be one step ahead.

Sivarasan did not prove to be a slippery fugitive for nothing. The enthusiasm in the SIT camp had started fading away. Verma started suspecting that Jack had realized his messages to Jaffna were being intercepted and decoded. So it was possible that he had chosen not to stop